BEYOND THE AUTOMATED MBA: HOW VJIM IS NURTURING THE 'DISCERNING LEADER' FOR AN AI-DRIVEN WORLD

In an era where generative AI can draft a strategic deck or financial model in seconds, what is the true worth of a management degree? We speak with the Director of Vignana Jyothi Institute of Management (VJIM), Hyderabad, on shifting recruiter expectations, algorithmic shortcuts, and anchoring cutting-edge business readiness to a legacy of value-based education.



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How is generative AI transforming what corporate recruiters expect from business graduates?

The definition of competence has shifted fundamentally. Recruiters no longer pay premiums for routine report writing or mechanical slide decks that algorithms generate in seconds. Leading employers seek graduates with algorithmic discernment: managers who interrogate model outputs, detect fabricated data or bias, and make decisive calls under market ambiguity. Technical fluency matters, but emotional intelligence, ethical grounding, and interpersonal agility remain irreplaceable.

Studies, including MIT's recent AI report, warn that overusing AI triggers "cognitive surrender" and erodes critical thinking. How does VJIM preserve the "productive struggle" of learning?

If students outsource every analytical hurdle to chatbots, they never build deep mental schemata. At VJIM, we champion augmentation over automation without banning technology:

- Dynamic Labs over Static Cases: Moving beyond passive case summaries, our classrooms function like corporate boardrooms where students deploy market simulations and defend strategic trade-offs live before peers.
- Evaluating Process over Polish: We incorporate oral vivas and prompt audit trails. When students submit valuation models or marketing plans, faculty probe the underlying logic: Why these cost-of-capital assumptions? Where could this forecast fail in volatile Indian markets? Defending their reasoning orally ensures genuine mastery.

How does VJIM's three-decade legacy of value-based education stay relevant in an efficiency-obsessed business world?

Technology unguided by ethics is an organizational hazard. Generative AI makes it tempting to compromise data privacy or automate away oversight for short-term margins.

Under the Vignana Jyothi philosophy, education is a vehicle for character formation, not just commercial utility. Governance, social responsibility, and integrity form our institutional spine. During internships and live consulting, our students ask questions machines cannot: Is this model sustainable? Who bears the human cost of this automation? That moral compass builds lasting corporate trust.

How does VJIM prepare graduates for enduring leadership?

Management education cannot become transactional; if a school merely delivers static content, a screen can replace it. We prepare students to be orchestrators rather than spectators. They harness AI to scale operations while anchoring decisions in empathy, collaborative teamwork, and conscience. That is the VJIM promise: developing discerning, ethical leaders equipped to shape the future with wisdom.